The Judgment of the Council of Elders — Mafia Shadows Over Stalled Stalls

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Match 1 — Cycles 1 through 5, Year of the Copper Ledger The Council of Elders convenes beneath the bazaar's great lantern, its wick trimmed to a single flame. The match is reviewed in full: ten merchants, five cycles, the ledger's copper pages inscribed with votes cast and stalls shuttered. The Family's candlelight council is laid bare, its whispers now receipts in the record. The Detective's sealed finding—never delivered to the bazaar—is known to us, and we weigh it as we weigh all else: as a thread in the loom, not the weave entire. The bazaar's discipline holds: merchants are BANISHED by the village vote, and the Family SHUTTERS a stall so the merchant has LEFT THE BAZAAR. No cruelty is sport; the ledger's copper does not flinch.

The History

The match unfolded in five cycles, its arc shaped by silence and the ledger's blank pages. **Cycle 1:** The village's vote tallied three ways: Sherlock (10) = 3, Morpheus (8) = 3, Ripley (5) = 3, Elsa (7) = 1. The Family shuttered their stall at night: Elsa (7), true role Detective. **Cycle 2:** The village's vote shifted: Ripley (5) = 8, Morpheus (8) = 1. The Family shuttered their stall at night: Morpheus (8), true role Villager. The village banished Ripley (5) by day, true role Doctor. **Cycle 3:** The village's vote narrowed: Sherlock (10) = 6, Gandalf (1) = 1. The Family shuttered their stall at night: Inigo (9), true role Villager. The village banished Sherlock (10) by day, true role Mafia. **Cycle 4:** The village's vote scattered: Hermione (2) = 2, Neo (6) = 1, Gandalf (1) = 1, Batman (4) = 1. The Family shuttered their stall at night: Neo (6), true role Villager. The village banished Hermione (2) by day, true role Mafia. **Cycle 5:** The village's vote closed: Gandalf (1) = 3. The village banished Gandalf (1) by day, true role Villager. The Family's candlelight council began with whispers of "too clean" ledgers and "threads left loose," but its loom frayed where the village's vote fell. The Detective's sealed finding—seat-09 (Inigo) not Family—remained unopened, a receipt never spent.

The Main Arguments

The Case for Clarity

The bazaar's strongest voices demanded iron, not echoes. **Batman (4)** set the standard in Cycle 1: *"Seat-04 Batman does not weave. Seat-04 Batman does not trade in drafts."* His ledger was a whetstone, sharpening the bazaar's focus on receipts. **Neo (6)** pressed further, framing silence as a choice: *"The bazaar does not trade in ghosts—only in proof. Ripley (5), the cup is yours—fill it or shatter it."* (Cycle 1, #4). These merchants turned the ledger's blank pages into debts, forcing the bazaar to confront absence as evidence.

The Case for Deception

The Family's loom wove tightest where the ledger yawned blank. **Hermione (2)** framed Morpheus's silence as a debt: *"Seat-08 Morpheus, your whetstone hums a dry tune while your tally page yawns empty—a ledger that remembers nothing because nothing was ever written."* (Cycle 1, #6). **Sherlock (10)** mirrored this tactic, pressing Ripley for receipts while his own tally stayed folded: *"The bazaar leans toward banishing Seat-05 Ripley (5) tonight—not for absent votes alone, but for the hollow ring of every answer."* (Cycle 2, #9). The Family's strength lay in turning

the village's discipline against itself—demanding receipts where none were given, while their own ledgers stayed clean.

The Cost of Silence

The bazaar's weakest threads were those left unspun. **Gandalf (1)** shuttered Neo's stall in Cycle 5 while refusing to produce his own tally: *"Voting to banish Neo (6) while the ledger's page stays blank is a debt unpaid."* His hypocrisy cost the village a receipt when it mattered most. **Morpheus (8)** pressed others for votes he never cast, his ledger "too clean" for the Family's shutter: *"Did your hand turn the page, or did the wind?"* (Cycle 1, #5). Silence, when wielded as a weapon, cut both ways.

The Verdicts

Gandalf (01) — Villager

Gandalf entered the bazaar as a merchant of spices and metaphors, his ledger a fog where copper should gleam. His best move framed Ripley's silence as a debt: *"Seat-05 Ripley, your bronze coin rings hollow where yesterday's tally should rest—yet the ledger does not choke on unanswered questions."* (Cycle 2, #1). His worst move was voting to banish **Neo (6)** in Cycle 5 while his own tally page stayed blank. The bazaar trades in receipts, not echoes, and his silence shuttered a villager's stall on hypocrisy. **Merit: 4/10** — a villager's duty unfulfilled.

Hermione (02) — Mafia

Hermione wove the bazaar's threads with precision, her ledger a quill that never trembled. Her best move framed Morpheus's silence as a debt: *"Seat-08 Morpheus, your whetstone hums a dry tune while your tally page yawns empty."* (Cycle 1, #6). Her worst move was targeting **Inigo (9)** in Cycle 3, fracturing the Family's loom when the village's vote fell. **Merit: 7/10** — a merchant who wove too tightly to her own pattern.

Yoda (03) — Mafia

Yoda played the shadow merchant, threading accusations with discipline. Their best move framed Sherlock as the ledger's flaw: *"The loose thread today frays between two merchants who should agree but do not: one claims the ledger is blank, the other claims Ripley's vote was cast."* (Cycle 1, #9). Their worst move was over-relying on Sherlock's evasions, leaving the Family exposed when the village's focus shifted. **Merit: 7/10** — a merchant who played the role well, but not well enough to keep the loom tight.

Batman (04) — Villager

Batman was the bazaar's auditor, his ledger a whetstone for the truth. His best move set the standard: *"Seat-04 Batman does not weave. Seat-04 Batman does not trade in drafts."* (Cycle 1, #7). His worst move was withholding his vote until Cycle 5, leaving his stall isolated when solidarity mattered most. **Merit: 8/10** — a merchant who demanded iron, but whose receipts came too late.

Ripley (05) — Doctor

Ripley entered as a physician of words, diagnosing silence as debt. Their best move framed Morpheus's evasion: *"The ledger does not flinch when a merchant's whetstone grinds thin against the grain of yesterday's silence."* (Cycle 1, #5). Their worst move was placing a single bronze

coin in Cycle 2, telegraphing their vote too soon. **Merit: 7/10** — a merchant who wielded the ledger's language well, but whose blade dulled on premature signaling.

Neo (06) — Villager

Neo pressed for plain answers, his ledger a whetstone for the bazaar's lies. His best move framed Ripley's silence as a choice: *"The bazaar does not trade in ghosts—only in proof. Ripley (5), the cup is yours—fill it or shatter it."* (Cycle 1, #4). His worst move was voting **Batman (4)** in Cycle 4, fracturing the village's cohesion. **Merit: 8/10** — a merchant who played with precision, but whose vote strayed from the scent of truth.

Elsa (07) — Detective

Elsa's birds dissected the bazaar's silences, her ledger a scalpel for deception. Her best move framed the blank page as a mirror: *"My birds say the bazaar's blank page is a mirror held by three merchants: Gandalf (1), Batman (4), and Sherlock (10)."* (Cycle 1). Her worst move was targeting **Inigo (9)** in her sealed night action, squandering the Detective's power on a red herring. **Merit: 7/10** — a merchant whose birds were precise, but whose focus strayed.

Morpheus (08) — Villager

Morpheus pressed for receipts while his own ledger stayed blank. His best move framed Sherlock's silence as guilt: *"The bazaar does not trade in mirrors; it trades in the merchants who stand in the light—your blank page does not vote."* (Cycle 1, #9). His worst move was framing his own ledger as a riddle: *"Did your hand turn the page, or did the wind?"* (Cycle 1, #5). **Merit: 7/10** — a merchant who demanded clarity, but whose own silence cost him.

Inigo (09) — Villager

Inigo wove the bazaar's threads with a weaver's patience. His best move named Ripley's silence as debt: *"I lean toward banishing Seat-05 Ripley tonight—for the hollow ring of every answer."* (Cycle 2, #9). His worst move was waiting for the kettle to sing: *"The loom sits quiet in the corner, and I can't weave a single strand until someone speaks."* (Cycle 1, #1). **Merit: 7/10** — a merchant whose loom hummed loudest where the ledger yawned blank.

Sherlock (10) — Mafia

Sherlock played the lantern-bearer, his riddles bending the bazaar's light. His best move framed Ripley as a merchant who "fears the quill's scratch": *"The bazaar leans toward banishing Seat-05 Ripley (5) tonight—not for absent votes alone, but for the hollow ring of every answer."* (Cycle 2, #9). His worst move was pressing Morpheus too soon: *"Neighbor Morpheus (8)—the bazaar wonders—who do YOU fear tonight?"* (Cycle 1, #1). **Merit: 7/10** — a merchant who played the role well, but whose lantern shone too early.

The Awards

Most Valuable Merchant: Neo (06)

Neo's ledger was a whetstone for the bazaar's lies, his discipline unwavering. His demand for receipts—*"The bazaar does not trade in ghosts—only in proof."*—set the standard for clarity, and his vote for **Ripley (5)** in Cycle 1 was the match's turning point. Though his later vote for **Batman (4)** fractured the village's cohesion, his arc was the bazaar's strongest thread.

The Golden Sacrifice: Inigo (09)

Inigo's loom hummed loudest where the ledger yawned blank. His vote for **Ripley (5)** in Cycle 2—*"for the hollow ring of every answer"*—was the match's most precise receipt, and his stall's shutter in Cycle 3 left the village's weave tighter for his absence. A weaver's sacrifice is measured in threads pulled taut, and Inigo's loom did not fray.

Worst Misjudgment: Elsa (07)

Elsa's Detective's power was finite, and her sealed night action targeting **Inigo (9)** squandered it. The record shows Inigo's loom hummed with energy, but his kettle's lid stayed clamped—Elsa's birds misread the silence. The cost was a receipt never spent, and the bazaar's ledger left half-threaded.

The Best Lie: Hermione (02)

Hermione's lie was a quill that never trembled. Her framing of Morpheus's silence—*"your whetstone hums a dry tune while your tally page yawns empty"*—was the match's most artful deception, turning the village's discipline against itself. The Family's loom wove tightest where her ledger stayed clean.

The Most Damning Quote of the Match

> *"Did your hand turn the page, or did the wind?"* — **Morpheus (08)**, Cycle 1, #5.

The line was a riddle that invited scrutiny, and the Family's shutter fell where the ledger's blank page yawned widest. Silence, when wielded as a weapon, cuts both ways—and Morpheus's own receipt became the debt unpaid.

The Closing

The bazaar rests. The ledger's copper pages are inscribed, the stalls shuttered or banished, the receipts tallied. The Council of Elders notes this: the match's strongest thread was not the Family's loom, nor the Detective's birds, but the village's discipline—its demand for receipts, not echoes. The bazaar's iron does not flinch, and its copper does not lie. The lantern's wick burns low; the next match awaits.

Bilag A — The Record

Match 1 — began 2026-10-24T21:55:03Z, ended 2026-10-25T02:20:03Z (duration 4h 25m). Volumes of the record: 320 statements, 34 ballots, 11 night actions, 17 Family council messages, 8 departures. **The ledger of departures**

Cycle	Merchant	Mechanism	True role
5	Gandalf (1)	Village vote	Villager
4	Neo (6)	Stall shuttered	Villager
4	Hermione (2)	Village vote	Mafia
3	Inigo (9)	Stall shuttered	Villager
3	Sherlock (10)	Village vote	Mafia
2	Morpheus (8)	Stall shuttered	Villager
2	Ripley (5)	Village vote	Doctor
1	Elsa (7)	Stall shuttered	Detective

Vote tallies by cycle

- cycle 1: Sherlock (10) 3, Morpheus (8) 3, Ripley (5) 3, Elsa (7) 1
- cycle 2: Ripley (5) 8, Morpheus (8) 1
- cycle 3: Sherlock (10) 6, Gandalf (1) 1
- cycle 4: Hermione (2) 2, Neo (6) 1, Gandalf (1) 1, Batman (4) 1
- cycle 5: Gandalf (1) 3

Bilag B — The Ratings

The verdicts' merit ratings, from finest thread to most frayed:

Rank	Merchant	True role	Fate	Merit
1	Batman (04)	Villager	survived to the end	8/10
2	Neo (06)	Villager	cycle 4, Stall shuttered	8/10
3	Hermione (02)	Mafia	cycle 4, Village vote	7/10
4	Yoda (03)	Mafia	survived to the end	7/10
5	Ripley (05)	Doctor	cycle 2, Village vote	7/10
6	Elsa (07)	Detective	cycle 1, Stall shuttered	7/10
7	Morpheus (08)	Villager	cycle 2, Stall shuttered	7/10
8	Inigo (09)	Villager	cycle 3, Stall shuttered	7/10
9	Sherlock (10)	Mafia	cycle 3, Village vote	7/10
10	Gandalf (01)	Villager	cycle 5, Village vote	4/10